

Lesson 5 – Practical Tools for Defining Your Purpose

Module: Understanding Purpose in Life (UPL) | Course: Youth Impact Training Programme (YITP)

Content Type	Text Content
Estimated Duration	60 minutes
Mandatory	Yes
Published	Yes

Learning Objectives

- Objective: Craft a personal purpose statement.

Lesson Content

Lesson 5 – Practical Tools for Defining Your Purpose

Key Topics

Core Lesson

Anecdote: The Fisherman and the Merchant

A wealthy merchant once urged a fisherman to work harder, buy more boats, and get rich. The

1. The Science of Purpose

People with purpose live longer, healthier, happier lives. Purpose reduces depression, increases resilience, and boosts performance.

2. Success Afrika Techniques

To uncover purpose, ask:

What makes me feel most alive?

What am I naturally good at?

What problem makes me angry enough to act?

What do others thank me for?

What legacy do I want to leave?

point to your core purpose.

3. Identifying Passions & Strengths

Purpose is not always obvious. Some discover it early; others stumble into it after decades. But you can speed the process by identifying patterns:

Passion: The things that energize you.

Strengths: The things you are skilled at.

Needs: The problems your community faces.

Rewards: What people will support and value in you.

Where these four meet lies the sweet spot of purpose.

4. Aligning with Values

Values are the guardrails of purpose. Without values, purpose becomes corrupted. Consider:

A gifted leader without integrity becomes a tyrant.

A wealthy businessperson without compassion becomes exploitative.

Purpose must serve the self and others to remain sustainable.

5. Folktale: The Hunter Who Chased Two Antelopes

A hunter saw two antelopes running in opposite directions. He tried to catch both but ended with none.

6. Drafting Your Purpose Statement

Examples:

7. Case Studies

Nelson Mandela: His purpose: freedom and unity for South Africa.

Mother Teresa: Her purpose: to serve the poorest of the poor.

Wangari Maathai: Her purpose: restoring the environment and empowering women.

Each purpose statement was clear, value-driven, and action-oriented.

Draft your purpose statement.

Share in LMS discussion forum.

Receive feedback: Is it clear? Is it inspiring? Is it actionable?

Refine it into one memorable sentence.

Takeaway: Purpose is not found; it is defined. You do not stumble on it; you craft it.

Activities

Activity: Peer Refinement

Inspirational Quotes

fisherman asked, "And then what?"

The merchant replied, "Then you can retire and sit by the sea."

The fisherman smiled: "But I already sit by the sea."

Psychologists call purpose a "self-organizing life aim." It integrates goals, values, and identity.

Exercise: Write answers to each question. Discuss with peers. Look for recurring themes—they

Framework: "The purpose of my life is to [action] so that [impact]."

"The purpose of my life is to heal broken families so that communities can thrive."

"The purpose of my life is to educate girls so that nations can rise."

Wisdom & Proverbs